

pend on global suppliers. He calls for focused policies to attract such specialised talent back to India.

Jaspreet Bindra, Founder of experiential learning company AI & Beyond, calls for a deeper shift in India. “The US and China are embedding AI into their national infrastructure. We’re still catching up in terms of digital readiness and sector-specific integration.”

As per Deloitte’s latest *State of GenAI* report, only 29% of the 200 Indian companies surveyed had scaled more than 30% of their proofs of concept. Major barriers include concerns about real-world errors, bias and hallucinations, and data quality.

These hurdles are compounded by the strategic choices Indian firms are making. Saurabh Kumar, Partner at Deloitte India, says most companies are buying off-the-shelf AI tools rather than building them in-house.

“This speeds up deployment, but limits customisation and innovation,” Kumar explains. “It also increases long-term dependency on external vendors.”

Automation of customer service remains the dominant use case, but there is appetite for AI across departments. Deloitte’s study points to interest in applying GenAI for IT, operations, marketing, and finance, where common use cases are document summarisation, competitive intelligence, knowledge management, customer sentiment analysis, claims processing in insurance, etc.

However, most of these applications are still incremental improvements, not transformative breakthroughs. “Indian enterprises need to move from AI-as-a-service to AI-as-core,” says Kumar.

Ganesh Gopalan, founder and CEO of Gnani.ai, which was recently selected under the IndiaAI Mission to build a foundational model, believes that AI adoption among Indian enterprises is gaining momentum.



“If 2024 was the year of AI experimentation, 2025 is the year of scaled application. From boardrooms to classrooms, AI is reshaping how India works and learns”

PUNEET CHANDOK

President, Microsoft India and South Asia



“Startup entrepreneurs are creating cutting-edge AI solutions, but our larger companies still wait for validation from Bay Area before embracing them. We need to trust and back our own innovation”

SHEKHAR KIRANI,

Partner, Accel

“The number of experiments happening now is 100x,” he says.

Gnani.ai primarily serves clients in the BFSI sector, where Gopalan notes that AI is no longer limited to customer experience. “We’re now seeing deployment in underwriting, reconciliation, claims processing, and more,” he adds.

However, he also points out that Indian enterprises remain “ruthlessly ROI-focused”. They are willing to experiment, but want results fast.

So, what will it take for India to evolve from an AI consumer to a creator? Experts agree that it’s not just about technology, it’s about a mindset change. Chandok of Microsoft believes culture plays a defining role. “Organisations that evolve from a ‘know-it-all’ to a ‘learn-it-all’ culture will unlock AI’s full potential faster than any algorithm can,” he says.

Meanwhile, Bindra warns that fragmented data ecosystems, regulatory ambiguity and shortage of AI-trained professionals in core industries continue to limit scale.

“India’s scale, talent and unmet needs make AI-first adoption not just desirable but urgent,” he emphasises.

Despite the roadblocks, optimism is high. The consensus is that AI is at an inflection point in India. What’s needed is a bolder push from both the government and deep-pocketed private enterprises.

For India, the path is clear: leverage the advantage in AI usage, mobilise talent, fix foundational gaps, and embrace experimentation. Only then can the country truly claim a seat at the global AI high table, not just as a user, but as a leader. **BT**

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